# NIKHIL RAJPAL

**Account Executive · Technical & API SaaS · New-Logo Hunter · Former Founder**

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## SUMMARY

Former founder and Account Director who co-built the sales playbook and sold API-based cloud communications SaaS at Exotel, whose customers include Amazon, Flipkart and Uber, from startup deals closed in days to $300K ACV enterprise contracts. Delivered 100–141% of a ~£640K annual quota for eight straight quarters, winning 5–10 new logos a month from self-built pipeline and converting 30% of 200–300 POCs a year. Earlier founded a five-brand cloud kitchen from zero at a 40% margin. MEDDPICC practitioner, hands-on user of Claude Code and Copilot, Salesforce Regional MVP. MBA, Leeds University Business School (2026).

## EXPERIENCE

**EXOTEL, India** **Apr 2023 – Sep 2025**

*Senior Account Director / Account Director*

API-first cloud communications platform (voice, SMS, WhatsApp, contact centre, AI voicebots) for 6,000+ businesses, from fast-growing startups to enterprises

- Delivered 100–141% of a ~£640K annual quota for eight consecutive quarters and won 5–10 new logos a month, by building my own outbound pipeline and running high-velocity cycles from first call to close, from days for startups to months for enterprise deals.
- Ran 200–300 trials and POCs a year and converted 30% to paid contracts, by guiding customer developers and engineering leads through API integration, evaluation and rollout; engineering teams evaluated about half of my deals.
- Converted 10–15 self-serve customers a year into enterprise contracts and grew a ~50-account book by 30% through expansion, by tracking usage and adoption and running QBRs with every account above $100K.
- Led multi-threaded deals across engineering, IT, security, procurement and legal, from ICs to C-level executives (CTOs, CIOs, CFOs), closing contracts up to $300K ACV and clearing security reviews (GDPR, ISO 27001, SOC 2) on 10–15 deals.
- Quantified value with TCO and ROI business cases tied to customer outcomes, including one that cut a customer's cost-to-serve by 30%.
- Closed multi-country deals with buyers in the UK, Benelux, UAE, US and Indonesia, including 5–6 UK–India deals a year.
- Co-built the sales playbook (discovery, MEDDPICC qualification, negotiation, multi-threading), coached six AEs (all above 75% of quota) while carrying my own quota, and fed customer feedback into product, pricing and positioning.

**SALESFORCE, India** **Dec 2021 – Dec 2022**

*Business Development Representative · Regional MVP (Mar 2022)*

- Earned Regional MVP as the region's #1 pipeline generator with £800K+ in qualified pipeline, built from scratch through phone, email and LinkedIn outbound; closed £150K+ in new business.

**LEADSQUARED, India** **Jan 2021 – Oct 2021**

*Inside Sales Solution Specialist · Spotlight & Star of the Quarter*

- Achieved 120% of quota, closing 15+ new-business deals (~£45K ARR) in high-velocity inside sales of CRM and marketing automation SaaS.

**EARLIER CAREER**

- **Founder**, Cloud Kitchen, India (2019–2020): built a five-brand business from zero at a 40% margin; cut costs 20%.
- **Underwriting Analyst**, AIG Analytics, India (2018–2019): built reinsurance risk models used for premium calculation across hundreds of policies, and trained new analysts.

## EDUCATION

**LEEDS UNIVERSITY BUSINESS SCHOOL · MBA** **Sep 2025 – Sep 2026**

- Won the Student's Choice Award for "AI Money Coach", an AI product concept judged by a panel from M&S, Lloyds and First Direct, and the Sales Accelerator Challenge (judged by an ex-VP Global Sales, Vodafone), displacing an incumbent priced 20% lower.

**PES INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, Bengaluru · B.E. Mechanical Engineering**

## SKILLS

Full-cycle new-business sales · Outbound prospecting and pipeline generation · High-velocity sales · Trials, POCs and technical evaluations · Selling to engineering and technical buyers (ICs to CTOs) · API and developer-facing SaaS · Multi-threaded deals · ROI business cases · Security reviews (GDPR, ISO 27001, SOC 2) · Self-serve to enterprise expansion · MEDDPICC · Sales playbooks

**AI tools:** Claude Code, Copilot

**Sales tools:** Salesforce, HubSpot, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, ZoomInfo, sequencing tools, Microsoft 365, Excel

**Languages:** English (fluent) · Dutch (learning, A1)

**Awards:** Salesforce Regional MVP · LeadSquared Spotlight & Star of the Quarter · Leeds MBA: Sales Accelerator Challenge, Student's Choice Award

**Interests:** National top-10 Scrabble player · state-level swimmer · competitive badminton

**Right to work:** Available for full-time work now · applying for UK Graduate visa in Nov 2026 (two years, no sponsorship needed)